UNIT
5

Cultural and Political Geography





Unit Overview

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5.1. Introduction

An interesting traditional Chinese custom says that a husband should carry his bride over a pan of burning coals before crossing the threshold of their home as husband and wife. According to tradition, the ritual ensures that the wife will have an easy and successful labour. Fire walking is also performed by some Chinese people as a means to prevent natural disaster'.

'In Cypriot culture, do not give white lilies as they are used at funerals. It is polite to finish everything on your plate. If you have not finished eating, cross your knife and fork on your plate with the fork over the knife'. It indicates you have finished eating by laying your knife and fork parallel across the right side of your plate'. Do you know some interesting custom practiced in our culture?

Learning Objectives

- *Understand the existence of cultural diversity and cultural traits around the world.*
- *Describe the world distribution of the tribes.*
- *Explain the concept of nation and state.*
- *Distinguish between Boundaries and Frontiers*
- *Understand political relevance of Heartland theory and Rimland theory to the present world.*

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Culture is the total way of life that characterises a group of people. There are thousands of cultures existing today and each contributes to global diversity. There are so many ways that people can be culturally different. Specifically, a culture consists of numerous cultural components that vary from one culture group to the other. Some of the cultural parameters are religion, language, architecture, cuisine, technology, music, dress, gender roles, law, education, government, agriculture, economy, sport, values, and many more.

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